

BEYOND SCHOOL SCORES / SHEET 1

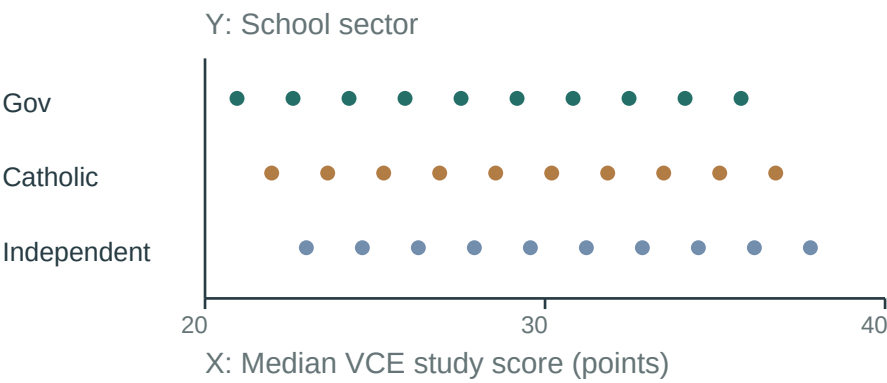
Detailed reference: what each axis, mark, colour and connection means

Audience: parents of primary-school children considering relocation for a Greater Melbourne government secondary school zone.

Core question: Before moving for a school zone, what should parents consider beyond a school score?

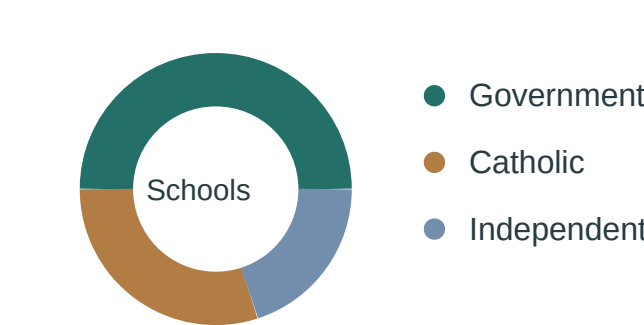
1 IDEAS / General chart types, with a concrete school-data example to make them readable

A Distribution dot plot



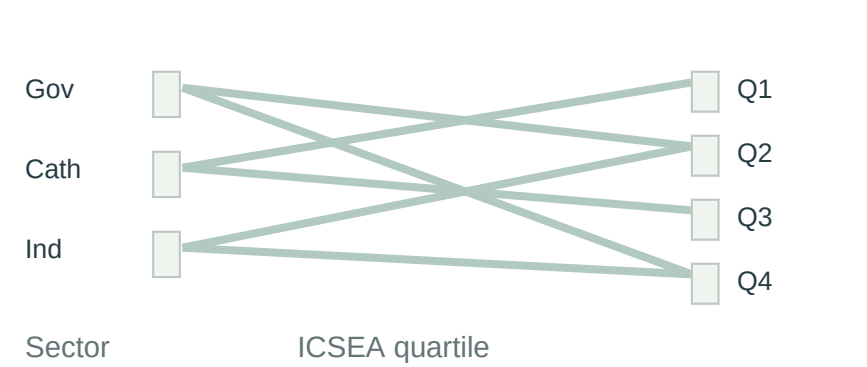
One dot = one school reporting unit in 2025.
Colour repeats sector; dot size is constant.
Read: spread and overlap, not just group averages.

B Sector donut



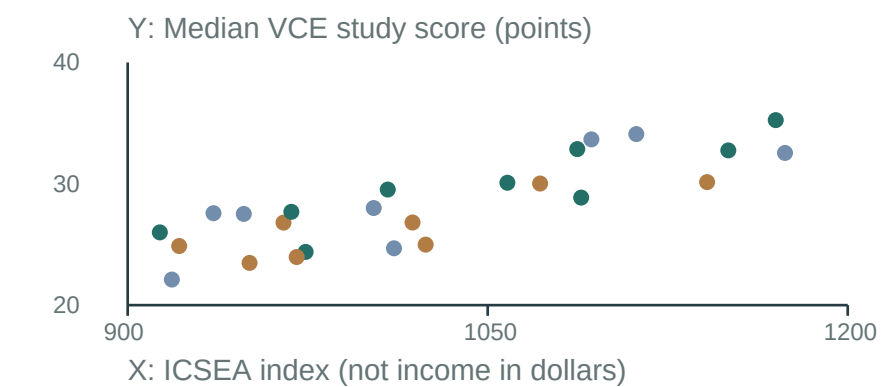
No X/Y axes. Arc angle = share of eligible schools.
Denominator: all schools in the stated 2025 sample.
Count schools, not pupils. Illustrative proportions only.

C Parallel sets / alluvial



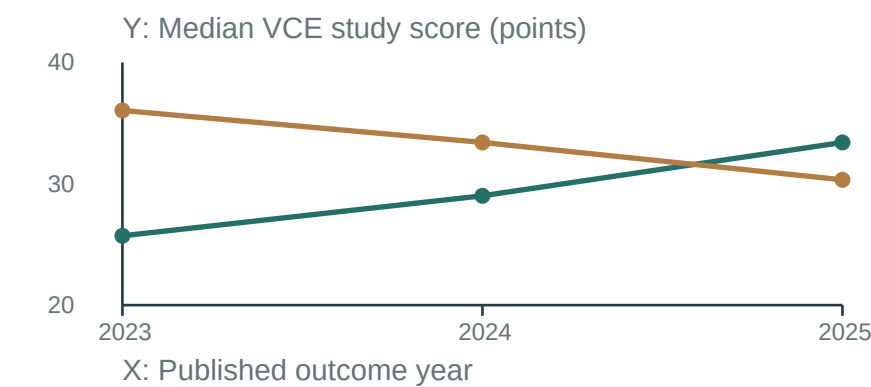
Columns = categories; no numerical X/Y axes.
Band width = number of schools in both categories.
Q1 lowest / Q4 highest ICSEA; define cutoffs.
One 2025 school per path; not movement or causation.

D Background scatter plot



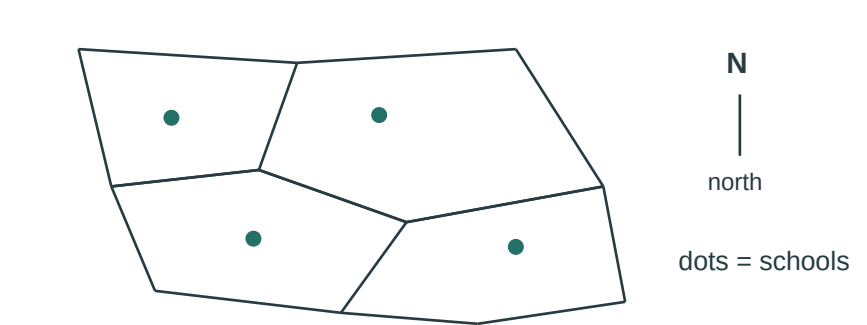
One point = one school with both measures (2025).
Colour = sector; all points use equal size.
ICSEA describes student background, not suburb wealth.
Read association; this does not estimate teaching quality.

E Three-year line / school trail



Teal = example school A; orange = example school B.
Each dot is an annual observation; line joins one school.
Same vertical scale throughout; do not fill missing data.
Three observations show recent change, not a forecast.

F School location + zone map



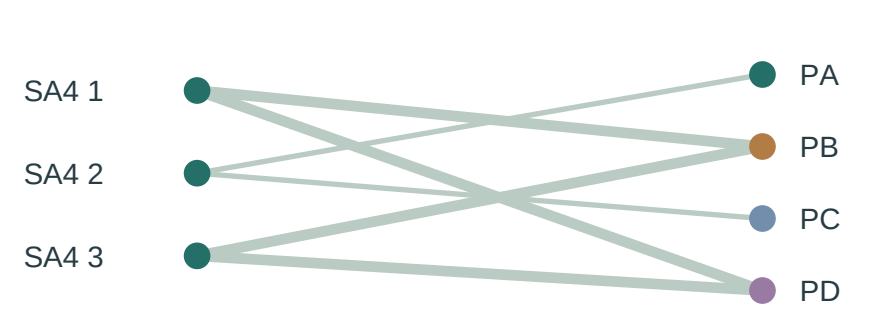
Position = geographic location, not score axes.
Polygon boundary = fixed 2026 school zone.
Teal points = schools; no size encoding in this sketch.
ICSEA range control can highlight matching schools.

G Schools grouped by SA4



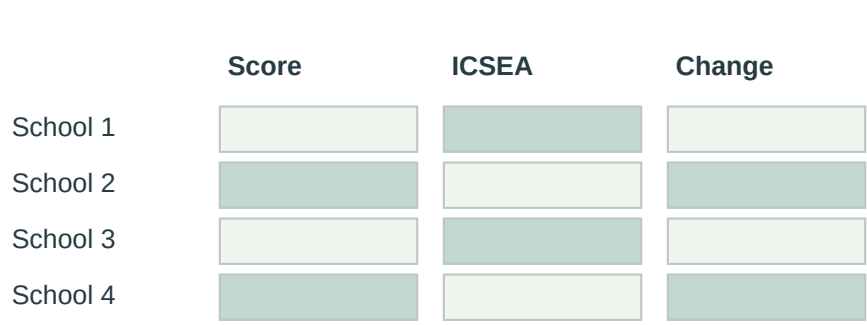
No X/Y axes. Enclosure = SA4; one dot = one school.
Colour = Profile A/B/C/D; equal dot size.
Only eligible, classified schools; layout is not geography.
Grouped dots are not a relationship network.

H SA4 - Profile network



No metric axes. Left nodes = SA4; right nodes = profiles.
An edge means schools belong to both categories.
Width = unique eligible schools; not student flows.
Profile names and colours are explained below.

I School attribute matrix



Rows = schools; columns = separate attributes.
Score in points; ICSEA index; change in score points.
Use column-specific legends; colour is not comparable across units. Real version needs values and legends.

READING GUIDE + DRAFT

Sin Chan / 7 Oct 2026

2 FILTER / Why keep or reject an idea?

A, D, E, F: retain for variation, context, time and place.
B: supporting summary only; proportions cannot explain score variation or improvement.
C versus H: test if categorical links aid understanding.
G: a simpler alternative when edges add no information.
I: provisional; too many cells may burden parents.
Never add unsupported school-to-school links.
Keep new visuals only when they improve communication.

3 CATEGORISE / Reusable ingredients

Comparison and composition: A / B / I
Association and membership: C / D / G / H
Time: E Geographic position: F
Narrative navigation: J / K / L

General type first; the axis labels on this guide show one possible school-data mapping, not a final design.

5 QUESTION / Check meaning and integrity

Can a parent explain what each mark represents?
Does each axis state the measure and unit?
Do legends distinguish sector, school and profile colours?
Do links mean membership, rather than causal effects?
Is the school count unique within the declared sample?
Can the intended insight be explained in one sentence?
Does interaction advance the story, not just filter data?

PROFILE KEY (eligible DEP sample only)
A: lower outcome / lower ICSEA / roughly stable
B: improving / mid-ICSEA
C: higher outcome / higher ICSEA / stable
D: higher outcome / higher ICSEA / declining

J Scroll + annotate

Scroll > reveal evidence in a fixed sequence.

K Interactive slideshow

Next/back > new scene + a limited local task.

L Drilldown story

Choose area > guided case story > return.

4 COMBINE + REFINE / Three different narrative experiences for the same audience and purpose

OPTION A / SCROLL

J + A + D + E + F

Magazine + annotated charts; martini-glass structure.
Sector variation > background > three-year change > local options.

OPTION B / NEXT SCENE

K + C + D + E + F

Interactive slideshow; one dominant stage per scene.
Classification > context > change > implications for a school-zone move.

OPTION C / CHOOSE AREA

L + F + H + E

Annotated map + drilldown story; bounded reader choice.
Overview > select SA4 > profile relationships + cases > takeaway / return.

A develops on Sheet 2; B and C on Sheets 3 and 4. Combinations identify ingredients, not a dashboard of simultaneous charts.

READING NOTES: School = the chosen reporting unit after linkage/deduplication. ICSEA = Index of Community Socio-Educational Advantage.

All values, node counts, colours and boundaries above are SCHEMATIC. No numerical findings can be inferred from these sketches.

Sources for final implementation: VCAA outcomes 2023-2025; ACARA background/location; 2026 government zones. Do not equate VCE results with IB/SEAL cohort results.

Method: fds-design.github.io | References: Tableau College Comparison 2013-2014; gapminder.org/tools | AI-assisted reference draft: OpenAI Codex, 7 Oct 2026.